

MedCore Hospitals & Healthcare Services Pvt. Ltd.

Performance Management Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes the framework for setting expectations, reviewing employee performance, providing feedback, documenting development needs and addressing sustained performance concerns at MedCore Hospitals. It applies to employees whose roles are covered by the organization's formal performance cycle and should be read with the employee's appointment terms and applicable HR processes.

Performance management is intended to connect an employee's day-to-day work with department priorities while giving employees a clear understanding of expected results and behaviors. It is an ongoing process rather than an activity limited to an annual review. Managers are responsible for maintaining regular communication, while employees are responsible for understanding expectations, seeking clarification and acting on agreed development areas.

2. Performance Cycle and Key Stages

The standard performance cycle follows the organization's financial year from 1 April to 31 March. HR may publish annual timelines for goal setting, mid-cycle reviews, year-end assessments and final documentation. Employees joining during the year may receive a prorated or role-specific cycle.

Stage	Typical timing	Primary purpose
Goal setting	At start of cycle / within joining period	Agree measurable role priorities and expected standards.
Ongoing check-ins	Throughout the year	Discuss progress, obstacles, feedback and changing priorities.
Mid-cycle review	Around September–October	Review progress and adjust goals where business requirements have changed.
Year-end assessment	March	Evaluate results, behaviors and development against documented expectations.
Final review / calibration	After year-end assessment	Complete the approved review and record the final outcome.

3. Goal Setting and Performance Expectations

Goals should describe outcomes the employee is expected to deliver and should be appropriate to the employee's role, level of responsibility and available resources. A goal may include a measurable target, quality standard, service expectation, project milestone or operational responsibility.

Managers should discuss priorities with employees before goals are finalized. Where priorities change materially during the cycle, the manager and employee should update the documented goal rather than evaluating the employee against an outdated requirement.

A performance plan should normally distinguish between:

- **Business or role outcomes:** deliverables, targets, project milestones, service levels or operational responsibilities.
- **Quality and process expectations:** accuracy, timeliness, compliance with approved procedures and reliability of execution.
- **Behavioral expectations:** collaboration, communication, ownership, professional conduct and responsible use of organizational resources.
- **Development objectives:** skills, training or experience the employee is expected to build during the cycle.

Goals should not be added retrospectively merely to justify an assessment. If an employee's responsibilities change, the manager should document the revised expectation and the effective date.

4. Ongoing Feedback and Check-ins

Managers should hold periodic one-to-one discussions to review progress and remove avoidable obstacles. The frequency may differ by role, but significant projects, new responsibilities and performance concerns should be discussed promptly rather than waiting for a formal review.

A useful check-in should cover progress against priorities, completed work, current risks or dependencies, support required, feedback from the manager and any agreed next actions. Employees should have an opportunity to explain constraints or circumstances affecting delivery.

Feedback should be specific enough to be actionable. A manager should identify what was observed, the expected standard, the gap where one exists and the action required. Personal criticism, vague labels or comments unrelated to the employee's role should not be used as substitutes for performance evidence.

5. Formal Performance Reviews

The formal review considers performance over the relevant period using documented goals, work outputs, role expectations, feedback and other relevant evidence. Managers should consider the complete review period rather than relying only on the most recent event.

Assessment area	Evidence may include
Results	Completed deliverables, targets, project milestones and agreed service outcomes.
Quality	Accuracy, rework, compliance with procedures and reliability of output.
Execution	Planning, prioritization, ownership, timeliness and follow-through.
Collaboration	Communication, coordination, stakeholder handling and team contribution.
Development	Completion of agreed learning, application of new skills and progress against development objectives.

Employees should be given an opportunity to discuss the assessment and provide relevant context. The final review should distinguish performance results from factors outside the employee's reasonable control, such as formally changed priorities or unavailable dependencies.

6. Performance Outcomes

The formal review records an overall performance outcome using the rating framework communicated by HR for the relevant cycle. Ratings should be supported by evidence and applied consistently within comparable roles. A rating is an assessment of performance during the review period; it does not by itself guarantee a promotion, salary change or other employment action.

Where the review identifies strong performance, the manager may recommend additional responsibilities, development opportunities or recognition through the applicable process. Where performance is below the expected standard, the manager should identify the specific areas requiring improvement and agree practical next steps.

7. Performance Improvement Plan

A Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) may be used where an employee's performance remains materially below the expected standard after appropriate feedback, or where the nature of the gap requires a structured period of improvement. A PIP is not intended to replace ordinary coaching for a minor or isolated issue.

A PIP should normally state the performance area, current gap, expected standard, actions required, support available, evidence that will be reviewed, review dates and the period during which improvement is expected.

- The employee should receive the plan clearly and have an opportunity to discuss practical constraints.
- The manager should provide reasonable guidance and monitor progress at the agreed review points.
- Progress should be documented using objective work evidence where available.
- If the required improvement is achieved, the manager should record closure or transition back to normal performance management.
- If improvement is not achieved, HR should review the documented history and applicable employment process before further action is taken.

A PIP does not automatically result in separation. Any employment action must follow the applicable approval and employment process.

8. Development and Learning

Performance reviews should identify development needs that can improve current performance or prepare an employee for future responsibilities. Development actions may include structured training, supervised practice, job shadowing, project exposure, mentoring or approved external learning.

The employee and manager should agree what capability is being developed, why it is relevant to the role, what activity will be undertaken and how progress will be observed. Completion of a course alone does not establish capability; application of the learning in the role may also be considered.

9. Promotions, Role Changes and Recognition

Performance information may form part of a promotion or role-change assessment, but a strong performance review does not automatically create a promotion entitlement. Promotions and changes in grade are subject to organizational requirements, approved vacancies, role scope and the applicable authorization process.

Recognition may include formal awards, additional responsibility, development opportunities or other approved mechanisms. Managers should not promise a promotion, compensation adjustment or benefit during a performance discussion unless the relevant approval has been completed.

10. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Understand goals, maintain work records where required, participate in reviews, raise constraints early and complete agreed development actions.
Reporting Manager	Set clear expectations, conduct check-ins, provide timely feedback, document material concerns and complete formal reviews.
Department Head	Review consistency of performance practices and support decisions requiring higher-level approval.
HR & Administration	Maintain the performance framework, provide guidance, retain controlled records and support formal improvement processes.

11. Documentation and Confidentiality

Performance records are employment records and should be stored in the approved HR system or controlled repository. Managers should maintain factual and relevant documentation and should not circulate performance information through informal channels.

Employees may request clarification about the basis of a documented assessment through the appropriate HR process. Performance information should be shared only with individuals who require it for legitimate management, HR or approval purposes. Records should distinguish documented evidence from informal opinions.

12. Review, Disagreement and Escalation

An employee who disagrees with a performance assessment should first discuss the specific point with the reporting manager. The employee may provide additional evidence or context relevant to the review period. If the matter cannot be resolved through the normal reporting line, the employee may approach HR through the applicable employee concern or grievance channel.

A disagreement with a rating does not by itself establish that the assessment is incorrect. HR may review whether the documented process was followed, whether relevant evidence was considered and whether the outcome is consistent with the applicable framework. The review should not replace the manager's responsibility to assess the employee's work.

13. Policy Governance

HR & Administration owns this policy and may issue annual performance-cycle instructions, templates and timelines. Department-specific performance measures may be added where they are consistent with the role and approved framework.

The policy should be reviewed at least annually or when there is a material change to the performance process. Where another controlled HR document addresses a specific employment matter, the applicable detailed document should be followed and any apparent conflict should be referred to HR.

14. Document Control

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